RTT within 18 weeks

Outturn for September 2026 · forecast issued with data through August 2026

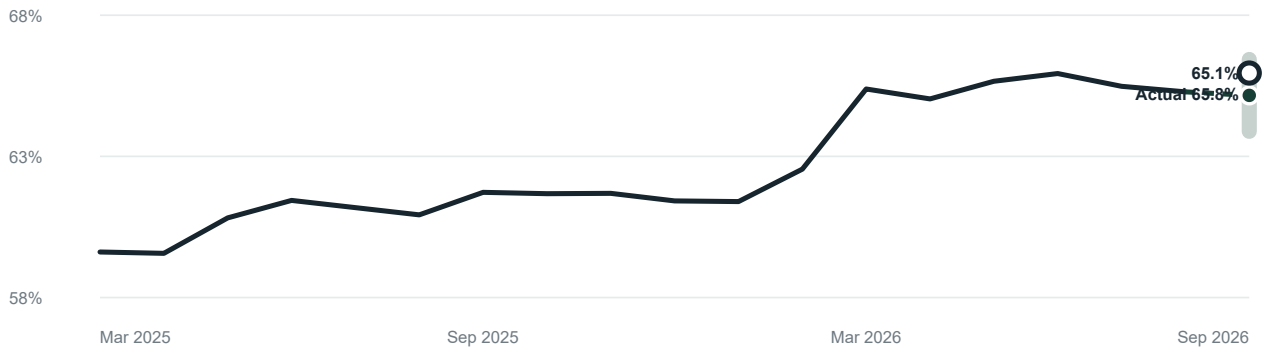
The published result was 65.8%. It improved 0.6pp from the previous result and was 0.8pp better than outlook · inside the 80% range.

AT FORECAST · AUGUST 2026	FORECAST · SEPTEMBER 2026	ACTUAL
65.2%	**65.1%**	**65.8%**
Known when the forecast was made	80% expected range 63.9%–66.3%	Improved 0.6pp from the previous result · 0.8pp better than outlook · inside the 80% range
		Off course · 70% by March 2027

Mar 2027 outlook at issue Projected **66.6%** Target **≥70%** Model-implied chance **6%**

Recent performance and current release

The vertical band is the 80% expected range.



Longer-term outlook and milestones

Descriptive projection; not forced to meet targets.



Benchmark: 92% constitutional standard. 3.8pp below milestone

Data: NHS England referral to treatment waiting times. **Targets:** Medium Term Planning Framework national target · Medium Term Planning Framework final target

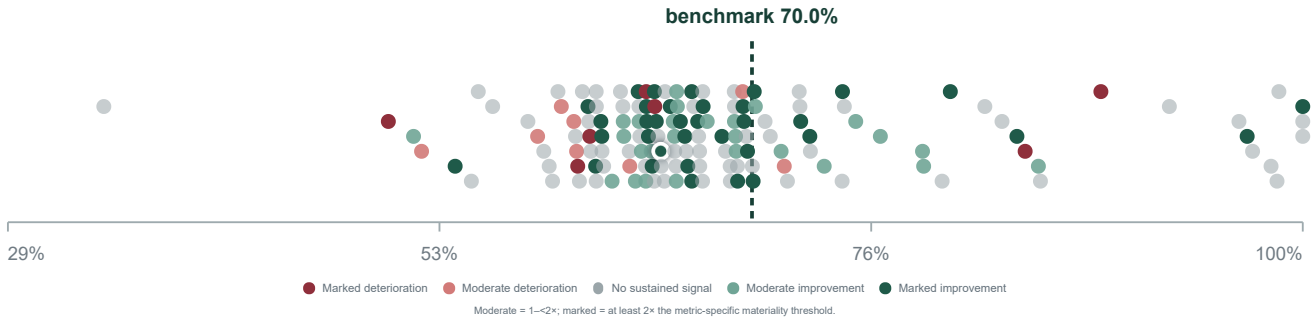
Method: Backtest-weighted ensemble of current-level seasonal movement, damped annual drift and a damped recent seasonal trend; at least 2 components are required. The final fit uses 230 consecutive months. Accuracy is tested on 36 rolling one-month-ahead forecasts. The 80% range uses empirical historical error quantiles from 24 forecast errors. Weights use inverse rolling RMSE and are shrunk toward equal weights. The pre-release commentary compares the current-level seasonal component with the combined forecast. Provider distribution and trajectory watch are shown on page 2.

RTT within 18 weeks

Distribution and trajectory watch · September 2026

Provider distribution

Latest reported performance across providers. This is a comparison of current levels, not a measure of whether each provider is improving or deteriorating.

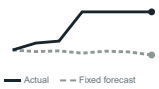


Trajectory watch

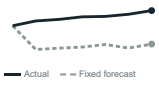
Six actual months are compared with one forecast path fixed before that window. Both lines begin at the same observed value. A low performer can be improving, while a high performer can be deteriorating. Status: Actual performance is compared with the monthly path forecast six months earlier. The displayed figure is the latest actual minus the fixed forecast for that same month; the six-month window checks persistence.

137	61	15	61
providers assessed	sustained favourable	sustained adverse	without an active signal

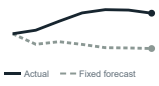
Largest sustained favourable moves

OXLEAS NHS FOUNDATION TRUST
Latest 100.0% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier
Forecast fixed before the six-month window


49.9pp
LATEST MONTH: ABOVE FORECAST

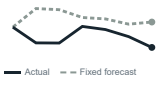
COUNTESS OF CHESTER HOSPITAL NHS FOUNDATION TRUST
Latest 69.8% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier
Forecast fixed before the six-month window


12.2pp
LATEST MONTH: ABOVE FORECAST

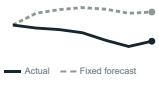
MID CHESHIRE HOSPITALS NHS FOUNDATION TRUST
Latest 69.5% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier
Forecast fixed before the six-month window


12.0pp
LATEST MONTH: ABOVE FORECAST

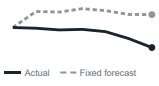
Largest sustained adverse moves

BRADFORD DISTRICT CARE NHS FOUNDATION TRUST
Latest 50.2% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier
Forecast fixed before the six-month window


11.6pp
LATEST MONTH: BELOW FORECAST

UNIVERSITY HOSPITALS OF NORTH MIDLANDS NHS TRUST
Latest 61.2% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier
Forecast fixed before the six-month window


6.4pp
LATEST MONTH: BELOW FORECAST

MIDLANDS PARTNERSHIP UNIVERSITY NHS FOUNDATION TRUST
Latest 89.0% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier
Forecast fixed before the six-month window


6.3pp
LATEST MONTH: BELOW FORECAST

Trajectory-watch rule. Six actual months are compared with the corresponding path fixed before the six-month window. The displayed gap is the latest actual minus the fixed forecast for that same month. A signal requires a material latest-month gap and at least five of six months in that direction. These are screening prompts—not league tables, causal estimates or judgements of provider quality.